

Chapter 163-2 Extra Chapter Five

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The news that Divine Venerable Chu Ling and the Heaven-Destroying Demon Lord were to be married spread like wildfire throughout the entire immortal and demon realms. Cultivators from all sects were so shocked by this news that they were speechless, running to verify it with their acquaintances. For a time, from distant hermit cultivators to disciples of various sects, everyone was amazed by this matter, unable to forget discussing it even during cultivation.

Even immortal cultivators couldn't escape gossip. The sensation caused by this matter even exceeded that of the Recruitment Assembly, and eventually even the mortal realm and the underworld heard whispers of it.

According to one dying mortal, that night the soul reapers who came to collect him all started talking about this matter. Several reapers got so excited chatting that they forgot about reaping souls all night. Unable to act once daylight broke, the reapers departed regretfully, and thus this person escaped disaster.

Wedding invitations from various sects flew like snow toward Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate. Whether the union of immortal and demon realms would bring peace between immortals and demons became a hot topic of discussion among all sects.

However, although this matter caused tremendous waves across the six realms, the actual wedding day was not grandiose but only invited a handful of people, keeping it extremely low-key.

Purple Cloud Peak was adorned with red decorations for ten li. Large red "double happiness" characters were pasted all over the stone hall exterior. Red silk hung joyfully from eave to eave, forming a fiery red net. Lanterns were scattered throughout the mountain like stars, and even before nightfall, the place was brilliantly lit, complementing the daylight.

Actually, according to immortal realm customs, marriage required petitioning the fate stars, worshipping ancient gods, offering sacrifices, and making vows. But since neither Ning Fuyi nor Chu Qingqiu were completely immortal, they simply simplified the process.

After all, even the wedding dresses they wore were from the mortal realm, so there was no need to be overly particular about other details.

Outside, the evening glow lit up the horizon. Ning Fuyi stood at the door wearing the finished wedding dress. The dress was designed to symbolize clouds, so the cloud shoulders rose high on both sides, and the long sleeves wrapped around her arms like layered clouds, yet were light rather than heavy.

Although she strongly opposed it, Jiuying still hung several strings of pearl ornaments around her neck, and her arms were full of gold bracelets and jingling arm rings, making them feel somewhat heavy.

Or perhaps it was her heart that felt heavy, unable to hide her nervousness.

She had removed both Emei Thorn and Xiangsi, placing them aside. They were now competing to hum, excitedly rubbing against each other.

"The Divine Venerable is ready! Once the sky darkens, it will be the auspicious time!" Han Ya poked her head through the door crack, speaking joyfully to Ning Fuyi.

The usually pitch-black crow was now dressed in peach pink, with two huge "double happiness" characters hanging from her ears, as if she were the one getting married.

Just as Ning Fuyi was about to say something, Han Ya was kicked by someone and pulled her head out of the door. After chattering for a few words, she hurriedly stuck her head back in.

"I spoke wrong—the auspicious time has already arrived!"

As soon as she finished speaking, the door suddenly opened wide. Red cloth spread all the way from the ground to outside the hall. Cheers came from outside, and someone set off firecrackers that crackled thunderously.

Ning Fuyi breathed out and crossed the threshold, walking all the way under the blue sky. The evening glow had already faded, and dusk was falling. The entire Purple Cloud Peak seemed to have turned into a bright candle, so bright it could be seen clearly from dozens of li away.

Many people surrounded both sides of the road, jumping and cheering joyfully—all familiar figures to Ning Fuyi. She walked across the red cloth amid their cheers, and when she looked up, she saw Chu Qingqiu just emerging from the door.

They wore identical clothing, differing only in the embroidered characters. But the same wedding dress appeared alluring on Ning Fuyi, while on Chu Qingqiu it was like red plum blossoms proud in snow—refined and devastatingly beautiful.

She was still somewhat bashful, her hands uncertain, her expression light. Seeing Ning Fuyi, she stepped forward and walked toward her.

At this moment, Bai Lin, wearing a large red flower on her head and with reddened cheeks, huffed and puffed as she flew overhead, countless petals raining down. Ning Fuyi laughed as she dodged the petals, extending her hand, and a soft palm fell into her embrace.

Chu Qingqiu, now closer, was even more radiantly beautiful. Her lips were painted with rouge, red as sweet fruit, her peach blossom eyes cool yet affectionate. After looking at Ning Fuyi, she shyly lowered her eyes.

"Do I look good?" Chu Qingqiu asked quietly.

"Absolutely beautiful." Ning Fuyi said sincerely. She looked at Chu Qingqiu for a long time, finally resisting the urge to kiss her and taking her hand to look eastward.

The eastern sky had not yet faded its pink color, half the sky dreamy and enchanting. Looking at this rarely seen pink firmament, Ning Fuyi thought of Ning Changfeng.

Mother, this must be your blessing, Ning Fuyi thought to herself.

"Paired swallows reflected, twin plum blossoms in the cold, bound hair as wives, love unchanging, in this prosperous scene and auspicious time, may fortune and blessing long endure..."

"Light the sky lantern!" After reciting the blessing words, Jiuying suddenly called out loudly. In the misty sky not far away, a copper-framed sky lantern appeared.

Ning Fuyi took Chu Qingqiu's hand and together they raised them. One black and one white beam of light surged from their palms, flying toward the sky like arrows from a bow. The sky lantern was instantly lit, flames shooting skyward, rising gracefully toward the clouds above.

In legend, sky lanterns carry messages to the stars, telling them that a pair of lovers on earth have become united.

As the sky lantern disappeared into the clouds, the ceremony was complete.

Cheers erupted around them again. Many people surged forward, dozens of hands patting Ning Fuyi's shoulders, continuously stuffing gifts into their arms as symbols of blessing.

Jiuying gave a precious qilin bone from the qilin clan, Liu Wenzhu presented homemade Nu'er Hong wine¹, Rong Jin offered bedding, Han Ya and Xi Que together gave a jade pendant made of demon jade, Hua Feihua presented an iron puppet for sweeping and washing clothes, and even Yun Ke rushed from Penglai to hand her a luminous mermaid tear.

Jiang Li didn't appear but had someone deliver her congratulatory gift along with a note that read: "I pursue my own path, until we meet again."

Many who couldn't attend sent congratulatory gifts. The gifts piled up like mountains in the stone hall. After Ning Fuyi and Chu Qingqiu put away the other gifts, they came out to see Liu Wenzhu holding her homemade Nu'er Hong wine, crying with sobs.

"Woo woo woo, my Yiyi finally got married, woo woo woo..."

"Woo woo woo, my Yiyi finally got married..." Jiuying, sitting opposite her, fake-cried in imitation, making everyone burst into laughter.

Ning Fuyi and Chu Qingqiu exchanged glances, also shaking their heads with smiles. They walked over to sit beside them, and Ning Fuyi was suddenly pressed into Liu Wenzhu's embrace, her strong arms nearly suffocating her.

After the ceremony, there were no more rules. Night shrouded the wilderness, bonfires blazed, and everyone sat in a circle—some drinking, some dining, chaotic but lively.

Several demon clan leaders danced strange dances around the bonfire, and the minotaur even removed his head to use as a ball, tossing it for entertainment.

Ning Fuyi didn't drink much. She just stared at Chu Qingqiu amid all the noise, watching her pretty face redden after Jiuying forced a pot of Nu'er Hong on her.

"Enough, enough." Ning Fuyi couldn't stand it anymore and reached out to stop Jiuying, but was pushed away by Chu Qingqiu, who told her not to interfere.

Chu Qingqiu's complexion was rosy with intoxication. She suddenly grabbed Jiuying, forcefully squeezing her shoulder until Jiuying grimaced in pain.

"You, you..." Chu Qingqiu struggled for a long time but only managed a few words, as if she had thousands of things to say but couldn't speak them.

Jiuying had originally wanted to get Chu Qingqiu drunk to help the two of them, but unexpectedly found herself grabbed by the intoxicated Chu Qingqiu with tremendous strength that she couldn't break free from.

"Ning Fuyi, I didn't touch your Divine Venerable—don't overthink it!" Jiuying was frightened out of her wits, raising both hands above her head and repeatedly reassuring.

Ning Fuyi looked at her helplessly and reached out to embrace Chu Qingqiu, but was pushed away by her.

Chu Qingqiu's eyes were rimmed with red. She stared intently at Jiuying for a long while, then suddenly released her hand and slowly pulled out a jade-white bottle from her bosom.

It was the Jade Pure Open Cloud Bottle.

The moment she saw the bottle, Ning Fuyi understood everything. She didn't interfere further but just sat cross-legged in place, quietly watching the bottle.

The instant Jiuying saw it, she also lost her smile and silently lowered her hands.

"What does the Divine Venerable mean by this?" Jiuying said.

Chu Qingqiu didn't answer but instead channeled a wisp of immortal power into the bottle opening, gesturing for Jiuying to extend her hand and touch the bottle body.

Although Jiuying didn't understand, she still did as instructed. The moment her fingertips touched the bottle body, a point of starlight suddenly lit up in the previously lifeless bottle, slowly blooming at the position of her fingertips.

Jiuying was stunned. She looked at the jade bottle in disbelief, moving her fingertip to the other end, and the starlight followed her movement, playfully flickering bright and dim.

When she let go, the starlight disappeared. Only when touched would the light inside shine.

"This is..."

"An artifact spirit." Chu Qingqiu said flatly. "White Bone couldn't develop an artifact spirit in several thousand years, yet this bottle developed one in just a few years."

"Even divine artifacts need a thousand years to cultivate a soul after bonding with a person, so I suspect that perhaps Qiu Yi's soul didn't completely dissipate."

Chu Qingqiu's voice was ethereal. Jiuying looked at the bottle in shock, moving her fingertip to the bottle mouth. A small point of light extended from the opening, softly wrapping around her fingertip.

A very small starlight, but with abundant life.

Seeing Jiuying lost in silence, Chu Qingqiu's gaze softened slightly: "Now that the world is at peace, I have White Bone by my side and don't need this divine artifact. Besides, this thing starts shaking as soon as night falls, clanging and banging—it's terribly noisy."

"Now that Jiang Li has gone to search for Black Scales across thousands of mountains and rivers, I don't have anyone trustworthy to entrust this to. Perhaps you could help me care for her?" Chu Qingqiu said.

Jiuying instinctively looked toward Ning Fuyi, who was obviously unwilling to help and was looking up at the sky.

"Uh... I..." Jiuying was rarely flustered. She twirled her hair and laughed awkwardly a few times, originally wanting to refuse. Unexpectedly, Chu Qingqiu suddenly acted drunk, leaning back against Ning Fuyi's shoulder.

"This venerable is drunk," she said dizzily.

"I'll take you back to your room." Ning Fuyi said quickly, then supported the woman and secretly escaped from the noisy crowd.

The two figures quickly disappeared. Jiuying couldn't call them back, so her gaze returned to the bottle. The starlight inside was still jumping around, making the bottle shake.

Jiuying had no choice but to pick up the bottle. The moment her fingertips touched it, the starlight suddenly slowed down, gently and softly nestling against her fingertips.

Finally, Jiuying lowered her eyes and placed it against her chest. She sat alone for quite a while before being pulled away by Han Ya to drink and laugh together.

The stone hall was also covered with red silk everywhere. Ning Fuyi dragged the soft-limbed Chu Qingqiu back to the bedchamber. The familiar flower bed was still there, only now decorated with red flowers. Chu Qingqiu's body fell limply onto it, and at the last moment she grabbed Ning Fuyi's collar and pulled her onto the bed too.

The laughter outside was blocked by the thick stone walls and could barely be heard.

Ambiguity spread. The intoxicated Chu Qingqiu was more indulgent than usual. Her eyes were red as she looked at Ning Fuyi, reaching out to loosen her collar while murmuring about the heat.

"Who told you to drink so much, knowing you can't handle alcohol well." Ning Fuyi laughed lightly as she fanned her, then mischievously leaned close and said, "It'll get even hotter soon."

Chu Qingqiu looked from her eyes to her chin, then glanced to one side, gesturing to Ning Fuyi: "There's ice over there."

Ice prepared for cooling was placed beside the bed. Ning Fuyi reached for a smaller piece and slowly put it in her mouth.

Some moisture stained her lips, charming and alluring. Her eyes curved like hooks as she lowered her head with the ice and kissed her.

Her tongue pushed the ice into Chu Qingqiu's mouth. Chu Qingqiu trembled, involuntarily gripping Ning Fuyi's waist, competing with her for this coolness. By the end, both their lips were somewhat numb from the cold before Ning Fuyi bit the ice to pieces, cool sweet water flowing between their lips and teeth.

Perhaps the intoxication had deepened—Chu Qingqiu's gaze was already hazy and scattered, her eyes full of blooming splendor. Her hand brushed over the wedding dress, removing Ning Fuyi's jingling gold and silver ornaments one by one, taking off the obstructive cloud shoulders.

The surrounding flower petals seemed to turn to water in her senses, sweeping her into deeper waves. Each approach of the woman before her made her sink deeper.

Her words became increasingly fragmented, breaking into intermittent calls. She abandoned all composure, her body lifted and curled up trembling.

Tears flowed down, reaching her mouth. In her daze, she tasted sweetness.

Outside the hall, voices and laughter filled the air, fires dotted the mountain, and clouds and mountains were one color. The moon emerged from the sea of clouds, overlooking this scene—a song of prosperous times.

Footnotes:

¹ Nu'er Hong (女儿红) - A type of traditional Chinese rice wine, literally meaning "Daughter's Red," often buried when a daughter is born and opened when she marries.